SCOOBY-DOO - MYSTERY INC.

#345-617

"Escape From Mystery Manor"

Written by

Bart Jennet

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SDMI_617_MYSTERY_MAN#B649EF -- CAST REPORT

Character

MAIN CAST:
FRED
SCOOBY
SHAGGY
DAPHNE
VELMA
ANGEL DYNAMITE
DELILAH

NEW CAST:
COSTUMED GIRL
~~COSTUMED BOY~~
CLETUS DARROW
DARROW FAMILY
LITTLE DANNY DARROW
OLD DANNY DARROW

COLD OPEN

TITLES: “Decades Ago...”

EXT. DARROW MANSION - HALLOWEEN NIGHT

Under a FULL MOON looms a big mansion with a couple of glowing JACK O’LANTERNS. It’s Halloween, circa 1920’s.

A COSTUMED GIRL dressed as a FLAPPER approaches the mansion door. She pulls the old-timey bell<RING>. CLETUS DARROW, the family patriarch, his face manic, throws open the door, a wedge of metal in his hand, covered with mysterious sigils. **

COSTUMED GIRL **

1 Trick or treat! 1

He knocks them down, trying to get past.

CLETUS DARROW

2 You’ll never get this from me, you little brats! Never! 2

COSTUMED GIRL **

3 <freaked> AHHHHHHH! 3 **

The Costumed Girl, terrified, runs off just as-- DELILAH, Cletus’ WIFE, done up like CLEOPATRA, lunges out and grabs him, dragging him back in. ** **

DELILAH

4 It’s MINE! 4

She tackles him and claws at his hand. The rest of the DARROW FAMILY, (a DAUGHTER, CASSANDRA and 11 year old SON DANNY who’s wearing a LINCOLN COSTUME) dog-pile on top of them, tearing at each other to get the wedge. ** **

DARROW FAMILY

5 <”GIVE IT TO ME!/ YOU CAN’T HAVE IT!/I’LL KICK YOUR SHINS TILL YOU CRY FOR MERCY!” WALLA> 5

INT. DARROW MANSION LIVING ROOM - CONTINUOUS

The family grapples, punches, pulls hair, bites... <NOTE: the mansion is lit with old-time gas lamps.>

DARROW FAMILY

6 <ASSORTED DESPERATE GRUNTS, YELPS OF PAINS, GUTTURAL BELLOWS> 6

Danny grabs the wedge and leaps from the melee, holding it like a prize, stovepipe hat crushed and fake beard askew.

LITTLE DANNY DARROW
7 I have it! I HAVE IT!! Ha-ha-ha! 7

But as he erupts in <CRAZED, MANIC CACKLING> the GROUND BEGINS TO SHAKE. He stops cackling. Suddenly everyone looks very afraid...

LITTLE DANNY DARROW
8 Daddy? Mommy? What's going on? 8

EXT. DARROW MANSION - CONTINUOUS

Grimly, inexorably, as though the earth itself were punishing this family for its greed, the ground opens up. The family <SCREAMS> as the mansion sinks underground and the land on which it stood closes over it. The TREMOR stops. It's as though the house were never there...

FADE TO BLACK.

ACT ONE

INT. ANGEL DYNAMITE'S RADIO STATION - NIGHT

The gang are all here. Angel finishes intro'ing a track.

ANGEL DYNAMITE
9 Angel Dynamite comin' atcha with the spinners spinnin' round for all you sinners in this town. Be right back, dig? 9

She spins a record and switches off her mic.

ANGEL DYNAMITE
10 Okay kids, lay it on. And don't hold out on me, a'ight? 10

VELMA
11 Okay here's the clues we have so far that we know are linked to the curse of the haunted treasure. 11

She WHAPS a pointer onto a big bulletin board which has all sorts of photos and items tacked up. First is the LOCKET.

VELMA
12 One. The locket we found in the Crystal Cove Caves... 12

NOTE: IF DESIRED, AFTER EACH ITEM, WHOOSH TO FLASHBACK, CSI STYLE, of CLIP OF SHOW IN WHICH THEY FOUND THE ITEM.

VELMA
13 ...which haa the pictures of Brad Chiles and Judy Reeves from the original Mystery Inc. inside. 13

WHAP on a photo of PROFESSOR PERICLES.

VELMA
14 Two. Professor Pericles. Also a member of the original Mystery Inc., who escaped from prison and vanished without a trace. 14

WHAP. A DARROW FAMILY photo from the 20's.

VELMA (O.S.)
15 Three. The Darrow Family, who disappeared... 15
(WHAPS photo of mansion and BLUEPRINT of it)
16 ...along with their mansion nearly seventy-five years ago -- without a trace. Which leads us to four. 16

WHAP she hits an embossed "E" item from an earlier episode...

VELMA
17 Mr. E. A mysterious ally, who's been leaving us clues to help solve this mystery. Which we still haven't managed to solve. 17

ANGEL DYNAMITE
18 Hmm. Well I got one more clue to add that might help. 18

She pulls out an old diary and hands it to Daphne.

ANGEL DYNAMITE
19 That landed on my doorstep this morning. 19

DAPHNE
20 Weird, it doesn't have the standard letter E stamped on the front. 20
(reads)
21 Dear diary. Man, I dig Ricky. 21
(MORE)

DAPHNE (cont'd)
Last night I fantasized that he took me in his big strong arms on a magic carpet ride, all the way to the mysterious perfumed gullies of Romancylvania.

FRED/SHAGGY/SCOOBY
22 Eew./Like Eew./Eew. 22

DAPHNE
23 Quiet, you three. 23

DAPHNE <SIGHS> at the romance.

ANGEL DYNAMITE
(uncomfortable)
24 Try the last entry before they disappeared. 24

She forcibly flips the diary to the end.

DAPHNE
(reads)
25 Dear diary, in our quest to track down the Haunted Treasure, we leave tonight, to search the site of the old Darrow Mansion. 25

VELMA
26 That's weird. The papers said they disappeared from the Crystal Cove Caves. 26

ANGEL DYNAMITE
(typing on computer)
27 That mansion used to stand where Darrow college is now. 27

FRED
28 Then that's where we're going if we want to solve this mystery. 28

EXT. DARROW COLLEGE - NIGHT

TO ESTABLISH. Under a moonlit sky (like in the opening) we see the college, in the same spot the Darrow mansion was. A few lights are on inside.

INT. DARROW COLLEGE - BOILER ROOM/STAIRS - CONTINUOUS

A rickety wooden staircase leads down to a cobwebbed room cluttered with junk and a big, menacing BOILER with all sorts of ductwork running up from it. The gang heads downstairs.

VELMA
29 The boiler room is the lowest point in the entire college! If the mansion is underneath, this'll be the best access point. 29

They reach the bottom and start searching the room, moving boxes out of the way.

FRED
30 Start searching, gang. 30

VELMA
31 If we're lucky we'll find a subtle clue that will help us. Be patient though, this could take hours of careful-- 31

DAPHNE (O.S.)
32 I found something! 32

Velma grimaces; damn it.

Fred helps Daphne push some boxes off a big old drainage grate set into the floor. They lift the grate up...

SCOOBY
33 It looks like... a chimney. 33

SHAGGY
34 Yeah, and like, I don't think Santa's been down it for a while. 34

THEIR POV - Slimy stonework leads to the side, out of view.

DAPHNE
35 I wonder where it leads? 35

FRED
36 Only one way to find out. 36

He drops into it. Disappears into darkness. Beat, then...

FRED (O.S.)
37 All clear! Come on down! 37

DAPHNE
38 Catch me Fred! 38
(leaps in, BEAT, O.S.)
39 Umpf! Ow! 39

FRED (O.S.)
40 What'ja say, Daph? 40

DAPHNE (O.S.)
41 Never mind. 41

Velma drops in. Shaggy looks at Scooby, a little anxious.

SHAGGY
42 Like, dude, time to drop out of college! 42

Scooby <GIGGLES>, they grab onto each other and drop down.

INT. DARROW LIVING ROOM - NIGHT

Shaggy and Scooby tumble out of a BIG, OLD FIREPLACE and roll out to where the others stand, dusting themselves off, etc. <WHUMP!> A stone trapdoor SLAMS SHUT, sealing the fireplace. Fred runs back and tries pushing on it, but no go.

FRED
43 Ungh! It's sealed shut! Is everyone all right? 43

Scooby and Shaggy have landed face-down in a pile of animal bones. They startle, scrambling back toward the fireplace.

SHAGGY
44 Like, define all right. 44

SCOOBY
(seeing)
45 Ba-ba-ba-bones! 45

DAPHNE
46 Where are we? 46

As they look around REVEAL NOW that it's the same setting where we saw the Darrows fighting all those years ago. It's remarkably unchanged -- except for the dust and animal bones lying around. Oddly the gas lighting is still working. (BUT IT'S STILL VERY DARK AND SHADOWY.)

VELMA
(consulting her blueprint)
47 If I'm not mistaken... it's the Darrow Mansion?! 47

The <CRACKLING HISS> of an old radio comes to life...

ANGLE on a table, where a really ancient RADIO crackles, lit up with an old-timey vacuum tube glow. And from the speaker comes an ancient voice -- the voice of DANNY DARROW, cackling, crazed and full of diabolical intent.

OLD DANNY DARROW (OVER RADIO)
48 Welcome back, Mystery Incorporated. 48
This time -- YOU'LL NEVER LEAVE!

With much <EVIL CACKLING LAUGHTER> from the speaker, the gang share a worried look.

CUT TO BLACK.

ACT TWO

INT. DARROW LIVING ROOM - NIGHT

The gang stares at the radio.

FRED
49 Who are you? How do you know us? 49

OLD DANNY DARROW (OVER RADIO)
50 I'm surprised you've forgotten, 50
mister perfect big chin man.

DAPHNE
(puzzled, bugged)
51 Um... have you two met? 51

OLD DANNY DARROW (OVER RADIO)
52 Don't play coy glamor puss! We've 52
all met, oh yes...
(EAGER LICK LIPPING and
WHIMPERING SOUNDS)
53 I've been waiting a long, long time 53
and I'm ready for your return!
Mystery Inc. will not get out of
this mansion alive THIS TIME!

He <CACKLES MADLY>, pausing to <WHEEZE AND COUGH> then <CACKLES SOME MORE>. It dies down.

Beat. The gang look at each other. Shrug.

SCOOBY
54 This time? 54

SHAGGY
55 Like dude, I think you've got us mistaken with someone else. But it was great meeting you, not really, and we'll be going... 55

OLD DANNY DARROW (OVER RADIO)
56 Quiet, you sniveling little whippet! I never could stand your cowardice. 56

VELMA
57 Wow, Shag, this guy's really got your number... 57

OLD DANNY DARROW (OVER RADIO)
58 And that goes for you too, miss know-it-all dumpy pants. 58

SHAGGY
59 Like, oh snap. 59

OLD DANNY DARROW
60 Now in honor of your return I've set some *very special traps*! 60

Fred practically vibrates with excitement.

FRED
61 Did you say *traps*?! 61

OLD DANNY DARROW (OVER RADIO)
62 That's right. Specially designed for my old visitors, Brad! You too Judy, Cassidy, Ricky and of course the ever-cunning Professor Pericles! 62

Note: while he says the above pan from one member of our gang to another on each name: these are the current members of Mystery Inc. who correspond personality-wise with the old members: Brad is Fred; Judy is Daphne; Cassidy is Velma; Ricky is Shaggy and Professor Pericles is Scooby.

SHAGGY
63 Ever cunning? More like ever-running. Hoo-hoo! 63

VELMA
(realizes)
64 Wait a minute. Those names... those are members of the *original* Mystery Incorporated! 64
(to speaker)
(MORE)

VELMA (cont'd)
65 Excuse me, demented speaker sir, there's a misunderstanding. See, we're not-- 65

OLD DANNY DARROW (OVER RADIO)
66 Enough! 66
(crazy HEAVY BREATHING)
67 You've always thought you were the clever one -- CASSIDY! But not THAT clever. No, no, you'll never get my treasure. YOU'LL NEVER GET MY TREASURE! 67
(CACKLE CACKLE)
68 And you'll never make it out of here ALIIIIIIVE!!! 68

The speaker <GOES DEAD>.

SHAGGY
69 Like, does he have to keep saying that? 69

SCOOBY
70 Why does he think I'm a bird? 70

VELMA
71 For some reason this guy believes we're the original Mystery Inc. 71

DAPHNE
72 Fred, what's going on? 72

FRED
73 Sorry Daph, I stopped paying attention after he said traps. 73

SHAGGY
74 Like I got an idea. Let's get outta here before we step in one... 74

At that moment Shaggy leans on a wall and CLICK. Instantly the gas on an old chandelier burns brighter revealing the room is clearly booby trapped in diabolically cockamamie fashion -- a deathtrap of Rube Goldberg complexity QUICK DUTCH ANGLE CUTS TO spiked panels, pendulum blades, guillotines, pits, bear traps, etc. all over the place.

BACK TO SCENE.

SCOOBY
(annoyed)
75 Nice, Shaggy. 75

FRED
76 Stay calm, gang. Clearly that crazy adult expects us to panic and run for the door, stepping on a pressure switch that's no doubt under that Persian rug. 76

ZIP to a Persian rug on the floor.

FRED (O.S.)
77 However, cool logic tells me that all these traps must have a bypass switch, which is located right over.... 77

CAMERA PANS LEFT, RIGHT...

FRED (O.S.)
78 There! 78

CAMERA LANDS ON an oil painting of a happy Renaissance boy taking an axe to a plumed hat, which sits on a stump.

DAPHNE
79 A boy with an ax and a hat? 79

FRED
(pleased with himself)
80 Ax. Hat. Ax hat. Exit! --No doubt behind that painting. Oh nutty elder man is good, but I'm better. Follow me, gang... 80

Fred pulls the painting aside...and all hell breaks loose in the room. A tripwire from the ceiling above the painting pulls a pin from a trap door that opens and releases a GIANT BUZZ SAW BLADE that swings down and shaves Scooby's back as he leaps just in time to shove Shaggy aside from a falling ax... knocking over a candle that sets off some black powder that launches a net over Daphne and Velma. They <SCREAM>.

FRED
81 Wow, that was sweet. The Kalabash Gambit. I've only read about that in books. 81

GANG SANS FRED
82 Fred...! 82

FRED
83 Don't worry gang, I've been preparing for a master trapper showdown like this my whole life. 83

Fred quickly grabs a lamp shade, spins it around clockwise, then slightly counterclockwise, then clockwise again, opens and slams a bunch of drawers in a side table in a strange sequence. There's a loud <CLICK> and all the traps retract/flip back around.

GANG SANS FRED
84 <WHEW!> 84

Fred steps up in front of them all.

FRED
85 Everyone stay close. 85

Daphne immediately hugs him tight from behind.

FRED
86 Er, Daph... not that close. 86

DAPHNE
87 Uh, sorry. It's just you get so swarthy when you take control. Like a trucker... With an ascot. 87

They get across the living room and down a WIDE HALLWAY where they arrive at DOUBLE DOORS. Fred slaps the knobs in a strange and silly sequence and the doors, actually a wall panel, pivot them around, delivering them to...

INT. DARROW MANSION - DEN - NIGHT

Everyone is elated.

DAPHNE
88 We made it! 88

VELMA/SHAGGY/SCOOBY
89 <"Whew, glad that's over" WALLA> 89

FRED
(smug)
90 Of course we made it. Ya hear that Captain Braggy Voice Trapmaker?! IN YOUR MYSTERIOUS FACE! *NO ONE* can touch Fred Jones! 90

Sadly, at that moment… KERCHUNK! A trapdoor opens and they all fall, <SCREAMING>, through the floor, splitting into two groups.

BLACKOUT!

FADE UP ON...

INT. DARROW MANSION - INDOOR POOL - NIGHT

DAPHNE AND FRED wake up on a tile floor. (WE DON'T QUITE SEE WHERE WE ARE YET.) Daphne is chained to a love seat. Fred is tied to a love seat nearby. (His hands are tied behind him, at a gap between the seat and back of his love seat.)

DAPHNE
Where... where are we?

FRED
I don't know.

More <SCRATCHY RADIO SOUND> draws our attention to another old timey radio, on the pool deck edge.

OLD DANNY DARROW (OVER RADIO)
HE HEEE! HAAAA!! <COUGH COUGH>
Think you're clever with traps, do you?

FRED
I kicked your staticky invisible butt!

OLD DANNY DARROW (OVER RADIO)
Oh those first traps were just a taste of things to come. Here, Brad and Judy, *here* is where things get truly diabolical!

DAPHNE
Our names aren't Brad and Judy!

OLD DANNY DARROW (OVER RADIO)
You're wasting your time trying to confuse me, Brad and Judy, for this is just a recording of my voice THAT CAN'T ANSWER YOU!

DAPHNE
Ah, but you did just answer me.

OLD DANNY DARROW (OVER RADIO)
What?!
(caught)
Arg. Okay fine, I'm here. You're quick. But are you quick enough for my next trap? Please take note, Brad and Judy, that you are in a swimming pool...

REVEAL: yes they are in a big, empty, indoor swimming pool.

FRED
102 You call this a trap, braggy old voice? You forgot to fill it with water. Daphne and I can breathe down here for decades! 102

GROANING <SQUEAK>. Water pours out of pipes in the poolside.

FRED
(worried)
103 Plus or minus... 103

OLD DANNY DARROW (OVER RADIO)
104 I've arranged this trap around the theme of love, Brad. Your girlfriend there has always wondered how much you love her. Now's your chance to prove it. 104

Quickly CUT TO VARIOUS ITEMS as the voice describes them...

OLD DANNY DARROW (OVER RADIO)
105 Your love seat is free to float. Her love seat is chained to the bottom of the pool... 105

Sure enough, Daphne and her chair are chained to a plate in the bottom of the pool.

OLD DANNY DARROW (OVER RADIO)
106 Attached to that float is an eggbeater... 106

An eggbeater lies near Fred, tied to a painted cork float.

OLD DANNY DARROW (OVER RADIO)
107 Next to the pool is a hammer... 107
108 By the door is a screwdriver... 108
109 A large rock sits on the pool deck. 109

Yep, hammer and screwdriver. ZIP over to said rock, like a lumpy softball-size.

Back to Fred and Daphne, looking increasingly concerned as the water rises up near their knees.

OLD DANNY DARROW (OVER RADIO)
110 If you're clever enough, you can escape this trap. Or you could stay faithfully with the girl you love. Let's just hope that whatever stuff you're made of... FLOATS! 110

More <CACKLING AND INCOHERENT BABBLING AND COUGHING> then the <RADIO GOES OFF>. Fred considers the situation.

DAPHNE
111 What do you think? 111

FRED
112 I think maybe I've made a terrible mistake, Daph. This man... this fiend... 112
(blown away)
113 ...is a *genius*! 113
(marveling, enthusiastic)
114 I mean I've studied some brilliant trapmakers but this guy tops them all. The slowly-filling pool thing -- and all those little clues which seem to make no sense -- wow! I mean, Fleebermeyer tried something similar in '41 but-- 114

DAPHNE
115 FRED! Stay on task! 115

The water is now up to Daphne's lap. She floats up, but then jerks fast as the chains hold her in place.

DAPHNE
116 If you can't get us out of this, then... well, move over to me. 116
(melodramatic)
117 At least we'll be together. 117

FRED
118 Sorry Daph, but I've got other plans. 118

DAPHNE
119 What? 119

Fred kicks through the water awkwardly, <GRUNTING>, to the eggbeater, which he grabs...

FRED
120 Gotcha! 120

He cranks the eggbeater, through the gap between seat and seat-back, and holds it in the water, propelling himself slowly toward the edge of the pool where the hammer lies.

DAPHNE
121 You're... not gonna leave me, are you? 121

FRED
122 No distractions, Daphne. Now the hammer... 122
(considers...)
123 Of course! 123

He grabs the hammer in his teeth and pounds on the tile till a piece cracks off. Quickly spitting out the hammer he catches the falling piece of tile carefully in his mouth. He flips it over his head and catches it behind his back. With the tile's sharp edge he cuts through the rope, freeing himself, and he climbs out of the pool.

FRED
124 And I am OUTTA there! 124

The water is now rising up Daph's belly. She frowns hugely.

DAPHNE
125 I'm not. 125

He runs, tries the door. Locked. Picks up the screwdriver.

FRED
126 I can use this screwdriver to remove the hinges and escape. *Very* nice! 126
(sees the rock)
127 But what's that rock for? 127

He picks up the rock, removes a little note attached.

FRED
(reads)
128 For weighing you and your sweetheart down, together, for all eternity. 128
(reading, not cackling)
129 Cackle cackle jibber jabber cough cough. 129

The water is up to Daphne's chest. She's near tears.

DAPHNE
130 Oh well, Fred. At least we'll be together. It's tragic... 130
(sniff, sniff, choked up)
131 But so romantic. 131

FRED
132 Sorry, Daph, didn't hear you. I was busy thinking about my trapmaking nemesis. 132
(MORE)

FRED (cont'd)
No way am I letting this end the way *he* wants it to.

Fred jumps in to the water holding the rock. Raises it high as if he's going to hit Daphne. She freaks...

DAPHNE
133 Fred, I take back the tragic stuff! I don't want to-- 133

SMASH! Fred brings the rock down on the chain holding the couch. The chain shatters, Daphne coming free.

DAPHNE
(realizing that he wasn't trying to kill her)
134 Oh, hee-hee. Good one, boyfriend. 134

Fred quickly pulls her to the side of the pool.

FRED
135 You okay, Daph. 135

DAPHNE
136 Oh yes, I'm fine-- 136
(reconsiders)
137 I mean... <COUGH COUGH SPUTTER SPUTTER> Just to be on the safe side, shouldn't you give me some CPR? 137

She puckers up but Fred just whacks her in the chest so she spits out some water <UAGH!>

DAPHNE
(annoyed)
138 I meant mouth-to-mouth CPR. 138

FRED
(laughs)
139 That would never do any good, not with all the water in your lungs blocking the air. 139

Daphne grimaces, frustrated. CUT TO BLACK.

FADE IN ON...

INT. DARROW MANSION - KITCHEN - NIGHT

Shaggy, Scooby and Velma come-to, sitting on the floor of a big, old-timey kitchen with black-and-white tiled floor. Crisscrossed FISHING LINE TRIPWIRES have them trapped.

SHAGGY
140 Like where are we? 140

Another old radio sits on a counter...

OLD DANNY DARROW (OVER RADIO)
141 You are nearly at your moment of doom! Well, two of you are anyway. 141

He <GIGGLES CRAZILY>. The others share a worried glance.

OLD DANNY DARROW (OVER RADIO)
142 Someone in this room is a big, fat, insecure know-it-all. But only the truly smartest member of your party can figure out this trap and escape to live. 142
(more GIGGLES, COUGHING)
143 Good luck! 143

The radio goes off.

SHAGGY
144 Big, fat insecure know-it-all? 144

SCOOBY
145 Who's that? 145

Beat. They turn and look at Velma.

VELMA
146 Oh come on, I wouldn't exactly describe myself as big, or fat, OR insecure... 146
(ramping up in insecurity)
147 ...am I? And I'm not really a know-it-all... At least I don't think I am and I may be big-boned, but I'm not fat am I and WHY AREN'T YOU TWO SUPPORTIVELY AGREEING WITH ME? 147

SHAGGY/SCOOBY
148 What? Oh sorry. You're awesome./Really, you're personality and physique are both very pleasant. 148

SHAGGY
149 And like besides, you're the only one who can get us out of here. 149

SCOOBY
150 Yeah. 150

VELMA
151 Better. 151

She pulls out a bulky Swiss Army grooming kit (looks kind of like a Swiss Army knife.)

VELMA
152 Good thing I never go out without my Swiss Army grooming kit. 152

She presses a button and <SCHWANGGG!> A nasty pair of industrial-sized eyebrow trimmers flip out.

VELMA
153 I'll just use my dainty eyebrow trimmers and... 153

She clips one of the tripwires. This sets off a spring that lets loose with a salvo of cleavers, which whiz past, almost cutting off their heads.

VELMA
154 Jinkies, maybe in this instance I'm not the "smartest member" he's talking about. But... it couldn't be you could it? 154

She looks at Shaggy, who scratches his head, pulling faces as he wracks his brain as he looks around at all the tripwires.

SHAGGY
155 Nnnope. Not me. 155

They both look at Scooby, who takes in surprise.

SCOOBY
156 (GULP) Me?! 156

SHAGGY
157 You're all we have left. 157

VELMA
158 Follow your intuition, Scoob. 158

Scooby considers. <SNIFFS.> Gets a thought. And slowly, suspensefully, winds his way through the wires, contorting, smushing down flat on the ground, curling his tail through and just missing...

VELMA
159 Just look at him. There's no way a human physique could wind its way through all those tripwires... 159

Scooby finishes his fancy moves and escapes the tripwires, standing by a kitchen table. He strikes a happy pose.

SCOOBY
160 Ta-daaa! 160

SHAGGY
161 Way to go Scoob! But how'd you know to go over there? 161

SCOOBY
162 Hee-hee-hee, I smell food! 162

He <GIGGLES> and flips a seed-cake off a plate on the table, <CHOMPING> it into his mouth. Then <HACK! HACK!> He coughs up a wad of paper, which smacks on Velma. She unrolls it.

VELMA
163 It's a clue! It says that to deactivate the traps in this room, simultaneously apply pressure to the four gray floor tiles next to you. 163

SCOOBY
164 Hmm? 164

He looks and jumps so each of his paws lands on four gray tiles, which are close together. Instantly <WHIP, WHIP SNAP!> the tripwires all retract into the walls and a door opens at the end of the room.

SHAGGY
165 We're free! Like, you did it pal! 165

He runs to Scooby and hugs him.

SCOOBY
166 Yay! Scooby Dooby Doo! 166

Velma steps up.

VELMA
167 Of course, it all makes sense. As the smartest, I decided to let Scooby get us out of this! 167

Shaggy takes the clue, looking at it.

SHAGGY
168 But like this clue is written for Professor Pericles, not Scooby. 168

Velma pouts, sticking out her lower lip. Then brightens.

VELMA
169 Aha, so in the old Mystery Inc. Professor Pericles was the smartest. He would have been drawn to the seed cake and used his wings and claws to press the tiles. It all makes sense, guys. 169

She looks noticing the open door, and the guys are gone.

VELMA
170 Guys? Hey, wait for me! 170

She runs out.

INT. DARROW MANSION - HALLWAY - CONTINUOUS

Shag, Scooby and Velma all run into Fred and Daphne.

DAPHNE
171 Oh thank goodness you're safe! 171

FRED
172 We made it past the traps. Now let's see if we can find a way out of this place. 172

They hit the end of the hallway and open a door.

INT. DARROW MANSION - DANNY'S STUDY - CONTINUOUS

The gang enter, closing the door and looking at this crazy old study set up with antique listening-tubes and a radio microphone.

DAPHNE
173 A radio microphone? This must be where that crazy voice guy is broadcasting... 173

VELMA
174 And look at all these old listening tubes. I bet he could follow our progress anywhere in the mansion. 174

Shaggy inspects a small fireplace with a roast rat on a spit.

SCOOBY
175 Eww... rat. 175

SHAGGY
176 Like, whoever this guy is, let's not invite him over for dinner. 176

Suddenly the door is FLUNG OPEN, revealing a DEMENTED OLD HALF GOLLUM-HALF EMACIATED CRAZY RECLUSE HOWARD HUGHES. This is OLD DANNY DARROW. He still wears the ragged remnants of his Abe Lincoln outfit, now way too short.

OLD DANNY DARROW
177 Don't worry, the only dinner being served tonight... will be you! No one outwits Danny Darrow! Ha-ha-ha! 177

He <CACKLES> with murderous dementia as we FADE OUT.

ACT THREE

INT. DARROW MANSION - DANNY'S STUDY - NIHGT

Old Danny Darrow is standing in the doorway, still <CACKLING>. Fred <SLAMS> the door in his face and braces it with a chair. Danny <POUNDS ON THE DOOR>.

OLD DANNY DARROW (O.S.)
178 You stay out of my room! STAY AWAY FROM MY TREASURE! 178

DAPHNE
179 That's little Danny Darrow? He's lived down here all these years? 179

VELMA
180 Why does he keep talking about a treasure? 180

Fred is busy searching the room...

FRED
181 We'll figure it out later. For now let's just get the heck out of here. 181

They all search. As Shaggy shoves a table aside a little chest falls off it, opening, and out spills that little wedge of metal we saw in the opening. Shaggy picks it up.

SHAGGY
182 Like dig this, a golden pizza wedge. 182

Scoob zips up, they both <LICK THEIR LIPS> and <CHOMP>.

SHAGGY
(crestfallen)
183 Only without the pizza. 183

Velma takes it.

VELMA
184 It's some sort of puzzle piece! 184

Danny's <POUNDING> gains force.

OLD DANNY DARROW (O.S.)
185 <HOWL!> My treasure! MY TREASURE! 185

He splinters the door, finally SMASHING IT OPEN. He stands in the doorway, <HEAVING>, brandishing a fireplace poker. Shocked when he sees the wedge...

OLD DANNY DARROW
186 You found it! GIVE IT BACK!! 186

With <MANIACAL LAUGHING> he chases them with his poker.

FRED/DAPHNE/VELMA/SCOOBY/SHAGGY
187 Aaaaagh! 187

They scramble. Scooby, in the lead, smashes a hole in the wall and they all pile in after him.

CHASE SEQUENCE: as the gang, trapped IN THE DEAD SPACE between the walls, run for their lives. Danny, on the other side of the wall, follows their progress, SMASHING through the walls with his poker, just missing them. They turn a corner and run on, away from Danny and his poker.

INT. DARROW MANSION - BALLROOM - NIGHT

A cavernous old space. A grand piano stand in one corner. Scooby BASHES a hole through a wall and the whole gang come piling out. They climb to their feet.

SHAGGY
188 We're trapped! Hoo-hoo! 188

VELMA
189 Not yet we aren't. 189

Velma pulls out the blueprint but just as she does Fred snatches it away, wild-eyed...

FRED
190 Sorry Velma, but these blueprints belong in the hands of a professional. When history writes its final passage, and we are but dust, this day will be sung of in the musical of time. Two trapmasters, born of flesh but skilled by gods, facing each other with traps on the field of battle.. 190

(big)
191 ...the acrid air BURNING IN THEIR LUNGS! 191

The gang look at each other.

SCOOBY
192 Ah... what's up with Freddie? 192

DAPHNE
193 Oh he's just in his zone. It'll pass, if not we'll hit him with an old shoe on the nose to make him stop. 193

FRED
194 Now follow me... TO VICTORY! 194

Fred <HOWLS> his war cry, starts racing around the room, gathering trap parts, gang looking on blankly as we...

CLOCK WIPE TO:

INT. DARROW MANSION - HALLWAY - NIGHT

Danny carefully prowls down the hallway, poker in hand. Just then, there's a haunting sound...

SCOOBY (O.S.)
(haunting, ghost-like)
195 Danny Darrow... Danny Darrrowww... 195

OLD DANNY DARROW
196 Whatsat?! 196

He creeps down the hall to a laundry chute door mounted in the wall. Above it an old sign reads "Soiled trousers, etc."

SCOOBY (O.S.)
197 This is your mother speakinnnng... 197

OLD DANNY DARROW
198 Mommy? You came back to me? 198

He eagerly pulls open the hatch -- only to see Scooby, hanging upside-down. Scooby plants a big <SMOOCH> on him, twinkles a wave, and pulls up, out of site.

OLD DANNY DARROW
199 You're not my mommy!... 199

He jumps in after Scooby, but falls in head-first. <WUAGH!>

INT. DARROW MANSION - LAUNDRY ROOM - CONTINUOUS

Danny lands hard in a wheeled laundry hamper <OOF!>, which launches down a jerry-rigged ramp, slams to a stop <UGH!> and throws him out into a clothesline, which stretches and flings him back, into a dumbwaiter <ACK!>, which shoots up...

INT. DARROW MANSION - UPSTAIRS HALLWAY - CONTINUOUS

...and into this hallway. He staggers into a rope loop on the floor. A chandelier down the hall, attached to a long, makeshift rope, drops, crashing through the floor, its weight hoisting Danny off the ground and through a wire hoop hammered into the ceiling. Danny zips through the loop, flying horizontally, over the wreckage of the chandelier, and CRASHES through the wall and into...

INT. DARROW MANSION - BALLROOM - CONTINUOUS

...the ballroom, where he lands hard on the grand piano, which CRASHES beneath him with a discordant <CLANG!!!!>, the piano wire flapping out and pinning him down.

The gang appears, surrounding Danny, who struggles against his bindings, <JABBERING> angrily.

FRED
200 Way to go, gang! Who's been served now, huh? 200

OLD DANNY DARROW
201 I won't deny it. You were a worthy opponent. 201

Fred, disarmed, blushes.

FRED
202 Gee, thanks. You're not bad yourself. 202

OLD DANNY DARROW
203 Was that a Gainsborough Stratagem you used back there? 203

FRED
204 You recognized it? You know I thought at first I'd go with the Orpheus Proposition, but I didn't have any milk... 204

VELMA
205 Excuse me? Sorry to interrupt but... 205
(wheeling on Danny)
206 What's the big idea trying to kill us?! 206
(whips out wedge)
207 And what's with this thing? 207

OLD DANNY DARROW
208 My treasure! I thought you had returned to steal it. 208

DAPHNE
209 Returned? I think you have us confused with the original Mystery Inc. 209

OLD DANNY DARROW
(blinks, looks closer)
210 Say, now that you mention it, you don't look anything like I remember you. 210
(re Scooby)
211 'Specially that parrot over there. 211

SCOOBY
212 Thank you. 212

OLD DANNY DARROW
213 Oh I've made a terrible, terrible mistake. What has become of me? I suppose it started that Halloween night... 213

FLASHBACK TO THE DARROW FAMILY FIGHT FROM THE OPENING. They claw at each other for possession of the wedge.

OLD DANNY DARROW (V.O.)
214 My family came upon a mysterious artifact. A key to finding the great cursed treasure rumored to lie beneath Crystal Cove. It corrupted us with greed... 214

Little Danny grabs the wedge...

OLD DANNY DARROW (V.O.)
215 I had just gotten my hands on it when the earth shook, and swallowed our entire house. My loved ones grew old and passed all around me, but I hardly even noticed. 215 **

ANGLE HALLWAY as a FLASHLIGHT bathes the scene, and in SILHOUETTE the original MYSTERY INC. looks in (design and board note: the original gang is seen only in shadow/silhouette. We do not need to see their designs in this episode Old Danny hides in the shadows in FG, cradling his wedge. ** ** ** **

OLD DANNY DARROW (V.O.)
216 Then those meddling kids showed up! They were after my treasure. I knew it! So I spied on them... 216

He starts preparing traps, sharpening punji stakes, spring-loading spiked panels, etc.

OLD DANNY DARROW
217 And I booby trapped the whole house in ways that would prey upon their weaknesses! Eh, but they left. 217

BACK TO PRESENT.

DAPHNE
218 So... you've been waiting for them to come back all this time? 218

OLD DANNY DARROW
219 Truth be told I kinda lost track. Has it really been that long? How do I look? 219
(worried, fusses with hair)
220 I haven't let myself go, have I? 220

GANG
221 <MURMURS of "no you look great, real spiffy," etc.> 221

OLD DANNY DARROW
(sigh)
222 My whole life has been a waste. 222

He sits in a plush armchair, which triggers yet another trap -- a spear flies past, and he ducks just in time as it THWACKS into the wall. He <LAUGHS SHEEPISHLY.>

OLD DANNY DARROW
223 One of my earlier models. 223

But just then the house begins to TREMBLE.

SHAGGY
224 Like is that my stomach rumbling... 224
or is this house moving?

OLD DANNY DARROW
225 No! All those traps going off must 225
have awakened the area's fault
line!

And sure enough, just where the spear is embedded in the wall a FISSURE OPENS UP, cracking down the wall and along the floor, separating Danny from the kids.

Fred tries reaching across the chasm, to rescue him.

FRED
226 Quick! Grab my hand! 226

OLD DANNY DARROW
227 Don't worry about me. This house 227
has been through worse. But now's
your chance for escape!

Velma holds out the wedge.

VELMA
228 But your treasure! 228

OLD DANNY DARROW
229 Keep it! And may it bring you more 229
happiness than it ever brought me!

Another TEMBLOR and now the chasm starts to close.

OLD DANNY DARROW
230 Now! Through that crevice before 230
it's too late!

The gang cast him one last glance, then look at each other and split through the crack in the wall, just before it closes.

EXT. CRYSTAL COVE COLLEGE - EARLY MORNING

The gang emerges from a fissure in the ground, <COUGHING> and waving away the dust.

DAPHNE
231 After all that... he saved us. 231

VELMA
(holds up wedge)
232 Or did we save him? 232

SHAGGY
233 Yeah, like he did say this wedge was... 233

SCOOBY
234 Cursed. 234

FRED
(takes wedge)
235 Whatever it is, it's our responsibility now. Question is, are there other pieces out there? And if there are, who else is looking for them? 235

As the gang ponders this, CAMERA REVEALS a car parked nearby. Inside is… FRED'S DAD! Looking grimly at the wedge in his son's hand, he rolls up the window and drives away.

FADE OUT.

THE END